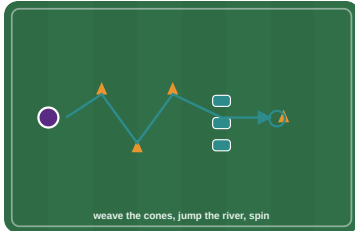




DRIBBLING WITH DIRECTION

Turns and changes of direction

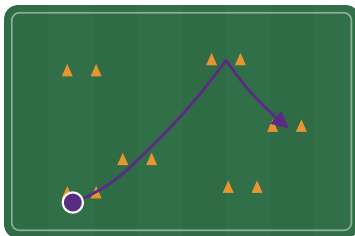
SESSION PLAN



WARM-UP · OPTIONAL Obstacle course 10 min

Build a course: weave through a line of cones, hop over a 'river' of laid-down pinnies, spin around a cone, then sprint back. Players go one at a time. A few runs with no ball first, then dribble a ball through the whole course.

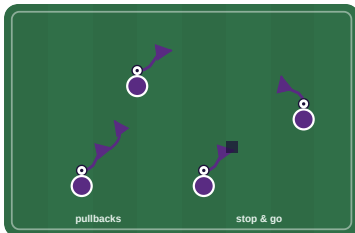
SAY IT SIMPLY "Weave and wiggle!" · "Big jump over the river!" · "Spin and go!"



PLAY Gates 15 min

Play this first, no coaching yet. Scatter eight to ten small gates (two cones about a yard apart) around the area. Each player has a ball and scores a point every time they dribble through any gate. Count points over 60 seconds, rest, then go again to beat their own score.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Heads up!" · "Find the next gate!" · "Turn quick!"



PRACTICE Pullbacks and stop-go 15 min

Now teach it: this fixes what just came up in Play. Everyone dribbles freely inside a grid, no cones needed. On 'pullback', every player drags the ball back with the sole of the foot and goes a new way. On 'stop', everyone traps the ball dead, then 'go' sends them off again.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Pull it back!" · "Stop!" · "Go!"

PLAY Small-sided play 15 to 20 min

Bring the game back so it gets used. Even teams, 3v3 or 4v4 to small goals. Light coaching, let them play.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Try a turn out there!"

WHY IT MATTERS

Turning lets a player keep the ball instead of losing it or clearing it under pressure. Working through scattered gates also gets players looking up. Their eyes come off the ball and onto the open space.

HOW IT DEVELOPS

- | | |
|------------------|--|
| U7 to U8 | Turn away from light pressure and add a change of speed as they come out of the turn. |
| U8 to U10 | Turns are used to beat a pressing defender and switch play. Scanning before receiving becomes a habit. |